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Consent to participate in research: Family Thinking and Feeling Study

Researchers led by Dr. Jeremy Fox, Associate Professor of Psychology at Montclair State University are running this study, "Family Thinking and Feeling Study," on Lookit.

Why we are running this study

You and your child are invited to take part in a study about how families respond to children's feelings and behaviors. We are interested in how parents' thoughts and beliefs connect to their parenting and child's well-being. We are following families over one year to learn how things change over time.

What happens during this study

This study takes about 60 minutes for you and 30 minutes for your child initially to complete. You will complete an initial online survey about your experiences as a parent and about your child's emotions and behaviors. Your child will complete their own online survey about their feelings, including about things related to school, friends, and family. Your child should complete their survey on their own. You may be nearby if needed (e.g., to help with technical issues), but your child should answer the questions themselves without your input. You and your child will also complete two follow-up surveys: one in about 6 months, and one in about 12 months. These surveys are shorter (about 40 minutes for you and 25 minutes for your child). You and your child can stop taking part in the study at any time.

Participation is voluntary

You are free to choose whether to be in this study. If you do choose to participate, it's okay to stop at any point during the session.

This also applies to your child. You and your child do not have to answer any questions that you do not want to answer.

What are the risks?

Risks are minimal. Some questions ask about emotions or stress. They might make you feel sad or uncomfortable. You and your child can skip any question or stop at any time. Your answers will not be linked with any information that could identify you. If you or your child feel distressed and need support, please use these resources: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (24/7): Call or Text 988; Crisis Text Line: Text HELLO to 741-741.

What are the benefits?

There are no direct benefits. However, this research may be used to improve programs that help family well-being.

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Data collection and webcam recording

You will be recorded by your computer's webcam and microphone only while providing verbal consent. This webcam recording is sent securely to the Lookit platform. You can view your past consent recordings on Lookit at any time.

Recordings are stored securely on Lookit servers and by researchers, and are only shared as described in this document. However, there is always a small risk that data transmitted over the internet may be intercepted or that the security of stored data may be compromised.

Who will be able to see your webcam recordings?

We will first check that you really agreed to participate by watching your consent recording.

Because this study only uses video recording for consent, your video data will be treated as "Private" by default, which means that the researchers with access to your recordings will not share them with anyone else.

Your child needs to be visible with you in the consent video. This is how we confirm your enrollment.

How we use your data

If you participate in this study, we (the research group led by Jeremy K. Fox at Montclair State University) will have access to

- webcam consent recordings
- your account profile and demographic survey
- the profile for the family member who is participating

This includes changes you make in the future to any of this information. We may put different types of information together to learn more about child development. For instance, if you participate in multiple studies from our group, we may look at how your responses compare across studies, or we may look at how your responses relate to other family members'. We may also study connections between your responses and family demographic survey data.

By agreeing to take part, you also allow us to use your survey data in future research.

How Lookit uses your data

The Lookit core team at MIT will also have access to your consent data in addition to your account data. They use this data to run and improve Lookit, for instance to provide technical support, check how well data collection is working, or see whether Lookit is reaching a diverse group of families. Lookit stores data indefinitely unless you withdraw your recordings at the end of the study.

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Publishing the results of this study

The results of this study may be presented at scientific meetings or published in scientific journals. We may publish individual responses that cannot identify you. We never publish birthdates or names. We never publish information that would make it possible to link recordings with your demographic data.

Compensation

You and your child will receive electronic gift cards (Amazon or Giftogram) for completing each survey. For the first survey, you will get \$15 and your child will get \$10. For the 6-month and 12-month follow-up surveys, you will get \$10 and your child will get \$5 each time. If you each complete all three surveys, you will each get an additional \$5 bonus gift card. These bonuses are separate – you can get your bonus even if your child does not complete all surveys, and vice versa. You will be paid for each survey you complete, even if you do not complete the follow-up surveys. To receive the gift card for a survey, participants must complete at least 75% of the survey (for example, participants must answer at least 75 of 100 survey items). Gift cards will be sent to your email within 2 to 3 business days after you and your child finish each survey. We may check survey responses to make sure they are complete and show real effort. Responses that are mostly blank or do not show real engagement may not qualify for a gift card.

Who will know that you and/or your child is in this study?

Your and your child's survey answers will be kept private. Any information that could identify you will be stored in a separate, secure file that is not linked to your answers. Only the research team will have access to this file. We will only use and share data that cannot identify you. Please note that New Jersey law requires anyone with reason to believe that a child has been abused to report it right away to the Division of Child Protection and Permanency.

Your rights as a participant

This study was approved by the Montclair State University Institutional Review Board, #25-26-4968. If you have any questions about your rights, you can call or email the IRB Chair, Dr. Sarah Kelly, at 973-655-3697 or reviewboard@montclair.edu.

How to reach us

This study is run by Dr. Jeremy Fox, Associate Professor of Psychology at Montclair State University. Please reach out to the study team at recap@montclair.edu if you have any questions about the study.

If you have any questions or concerns about the Lookit platform, please contact Lookit staff at lookit@mit.edu.